will to fight, and then attack, if necessary. In the meanwhile, it could be ensured that innocent pilgrims trapped in the Golden Temple complex were induced to come out. In that case, the army could neutralize the militants with not more than twenty to thirty casualties from its ranks.

Maj. Gen. Brar, who didn't like Pandher's suggestion, said that he was also a Jat Sikh and knew the Jat Sikh psychology well. In response, Pandher said, 'Sir, don't mind me saying, but you don't look like a Jat Sikh. A Jat Sikh must have a beard on his face and turban over his head. Also, he should be born and brought up in a village, like me. In view of that I know their psychology much better. You can at best be considered a modified Jat Sikh.' A furious Brar insisted on carrying out the surgical operation as planned. Pandher told Brar that in that case he would like to get his orders in writing as to what was expected of him and his force, as he apprehended a judicial enquiry headed by a serving or retired Supreme Court judge later.

In that context, Pandher referred to the Hunter Commission appointed in October 1919 to inquire into the various aspects of the infamous Jallianwala Bagh (located next door to the Golden Temple) massacre of 13 April 1919. At that point, Maj. Gen. Brar lost his temper and thumped the table a few times, accusing Pandher of open mutiny, and adding that for a soldier, 'theirs not to reason why, theirs but to do and die'. Pandher responded with, 'Sir, this must be true for the army but police officers are trained to consider all available softer options before taking such a drastic action.'

After the meeting, Pandher sent a report to the BSF headquarters in New Delhi, giving his views on Maj. Gen. Brar's planned surgical operation as well as his own suggestions. Brar received a copy of that report from Delhi early in the morning of 4 June, and he held a second meeting of the same officers at 10 a.m. that day. He asked Pandher why he had sent a report to his headquarters, to which Pandher replied that it was his duty to keep his bosses fully informed of the ground situation and he would continue to do so in future too.

Not liking that answer, Brar had Pandher removed from the charge of DIG BSF, Amritsar, made him proceed on thirty days'